

PRAVEEN VADLAKONDA

Engineering Manager | Senior Software Engineer | Distributed Systems & Cloud Architecture

 Dallas-Fort Worth

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 [LinkedIn Profile](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering Manager and technical leader with nearly 20 years of experience building, scaling, and leading high-performance engineering teams delivering distributed, cloud-native systems. Currently a Software Development Manager at Amazon, known for aligning technical strategy with business outcomes, developing strong engineering talent, and driving operational excellence at scale. Proven track record of mentoring engineers, executing complex roadmaps, and fostering cultures of ownership, quality, and continuous improvement.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Engineering Management & People Leadership
- Team Hiring, Mentorship & Career Development
- System Design, Clean Code & Technical Excellence
- Cross-Functional & Executive Stakeholder Management
- Distributed Systems & AWS Cloud Architecture
- Agile Delivery, SDLC & Roadmap Execution
- Operational Excellence, Reliability & CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Amazon

Dallas, TX

Software Development Manager | Senior Software Development Engineer III

November 2023 – Present

- Lead and mentor a team of 8–10 engineers across mission-critical distributed systems supporting millions of requests per day.
- Own architectural standards and influence 3+ cross-team roadmaps, improving system reliability and scalability while reducing long-term maintenance cost.
- Led operational excellence initiatives including on-call ownership, incident response, and post-incident reviews, helping maintain 99.99% service availability across multiple production services.
- Oversaw response and remediation for SEV-2 incidents and participated in escalations, driving root cause analysis and long-term corrective actions.
- Improved service availability and operational readiness, contributing to a ~30% reduction in recurring operational issues.
- Drive delivery across the full SDLC, consistently meeting roadmap commitments while balancing short-term business needs with long-term technical health.
- Act as a bar-raiser in hiring and performance evaluations, interviewing 50+ candidates annually and strengthening overall engineering quality.
- Partner with product, program, and senior leadership to align engineering execution with organizational goals.

Software Development Engineer

January 2020 – December 2023

- Led end-to-end design and implementation of scalable AWS-based services handling high-traffic workloads at enterprise scale.
- Owned operational health for critical services, contributing to sustained 99.99% availability through proactive monitoring, alarms, dashboards, and well-defined operational playbooks.
- Implemented auto-cut alarms on canary deployments and integration tests, enabling early detection and rollback of issues before customer impact.
- Actively participated in on-call rotations, responding to SEV-2 incidents, reducing alert fatigue and improving incident response time.
- Improved system performance and reliability, reducing mean time to recovery (MTTR) by ~25%.
- Reduced operational overhead and improved deployment velocity through CI/CD automation and service modularization.
- Served as a technical mentor and design reviewer for 10+ engineers, raising the bar on system design and code quality across the organization.

American Airlines

DFW Metroplex

Software Engineering Manager

August 2017 – December 2019

- Managed and grew a high-performing engineering team of 6–8 engineers, overseeing hiring, onboarding, performance management, and career progression.
- Defined technical vision and led delivery for enterprise applications supporting core airline operations used by thousands of internal users.
- Improved delivery predictability and throughput by ~35% through adoption of agile practices, clear ownership models, and engineering metrics.
- Successfully delivered multiple strategic IT initiatives while meeting strict uptime, security, and compliance requirements.
- Acted as a primary liaison between engineering, product, and business stakeholders.

Senior Software Engineer

August 2014 – August 2017

- Architected and delivered enterprise-grade systems serving large-scale, business-critical workflows with strong uptime and reliability requirements.
- Mentored 5+ junior engineers, contributing to stronger team capability, retention, and promotion readiness.

Software Engineer

December 2011 – August 2014

- Built and maintained core business applications supporting revenue-impacting business processes.
- Partnered directly with business units to deliver features with measurable improvements in quality and turnaround time.

Blue Cross Blue Shield Association

Dallas, TX

Java Developer | October 2010 – December 2011

- Designed and implemented backend services for healthcare data processing with compliance to industry and regulatory standards.

AT&T

Dallas, TX

Java Developer

April 2007 – October 2010

- Contributed across the full software development lifecycle, modernizing and optimizing legacy systems to improve performance and reliability.

CSAA Insurance Group (AAA Insurer)

Bay Area, CA

Java Developer

June 2006 – March 2007

- Developed backend systems supporting insurance platforms.

AT&T

New Jersey

Junior Java Developer

October 2005 – April 2006

- Supported software development activities and gained hands-on experience in Java programming, debugging, and testing under senior developer guidance.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Master of Science (MS), Software Engineering

Southern Methodist University

2004 – 2006

Bachelor of Technology (BTech), Computer Science and Information Technology

JNTU, Hyderabad, India

2000 – 2004

Certifications:

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- Oracle Certified Associate, Java SE 8 Programmer

LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY

I believe great systems are built by great teams. My leadership approach centers on system optimization through people—creating environments with high trust, strong ownership, and continuous learning. I focus on developing engineers into technical and leadership multipliers while ensuring the software we build is scalable, maintainable, and built to last.